

PRACTICE INSTRUCTION

Part: Construction Services

Instruction: Site Observation Instruction

Document No.: 6.01.03

Date: 11 Apr 2020

Issue	Description	Date	Approved
1.0	First Draft	16 Nov 2018	
1.1	First Issue	31 Jan 2019	P. Seager
1.2	Revised content of site observation report	11 Apr 2020	P. Seager

1 GENERAL

1.01 SCOPE

- 1.01.01 This practice instruction describes the requirements for conducting site observations of construction work.

NOTE: A site observation report should always be issued before a contractors progress draw is processed.

NOTE: This instruction is prepared based on using the TAG Project Services > Construction Review application. For legacy projects which predate the introduction of this software system, equivalent manual (Word, Excel) documents are used.

2 SITE OBSERVATION PROCESS

2.01 GENERAL

- 2.01.01 The Site Observation report is provided for the benefit of the Owner, to advise the Owner as to general progress on site, and includes:
- (1) names of people present during the review (minimum is the staff reviewer);
 - (2) date of visit and date of report;
 - (3) purpose of the report - typically "monthly review" or "Bi-weekly review", but may be specific to only some element of the work;

- (4) observations of work activity and progress,
- (5) any noted deficiencies.

These reports are usually conducted on an agreed periodic basis, such as bi-weekly or once a month. At early stages of the project where no building service work is performed, these site visits may not be conducted.

These reports shall be provided whenever a visit is made to the Work while the applicable trade contractors are actively working on site.

2.01.02 Site Observation reports are processed through the TAG Project Services > Construction Review database system (see figures 1 and 2). This automated process allows;

- (1) recording of deficiencies (with photos if applicable);
- (2) recording of observations made during the visit;
- (3) creation of the Site Observation report;
- (4) issuing of the Site Observation report and any noted deficiencies, automatically by email, or by semi-automatically where a project external on-line document management system is used.

2.01.03 Where a project online deficiency reporting system is used (typically hosted by others), the following sub-process is used:

- (1) deficiencies are recorded on the online service;
- (2) a PDF copy of a deficiency report is downloaded from that system, and uploaded to the TAG system as a single deficiency with attachment;
- (3) the Site Observation report is completed and will include the deficiency report.

NOTE: Where an online deficiency reporting system is used, it will not be possible to search deficiencies directly on TAG, or to track their status. Such functions must be performed using the online service.

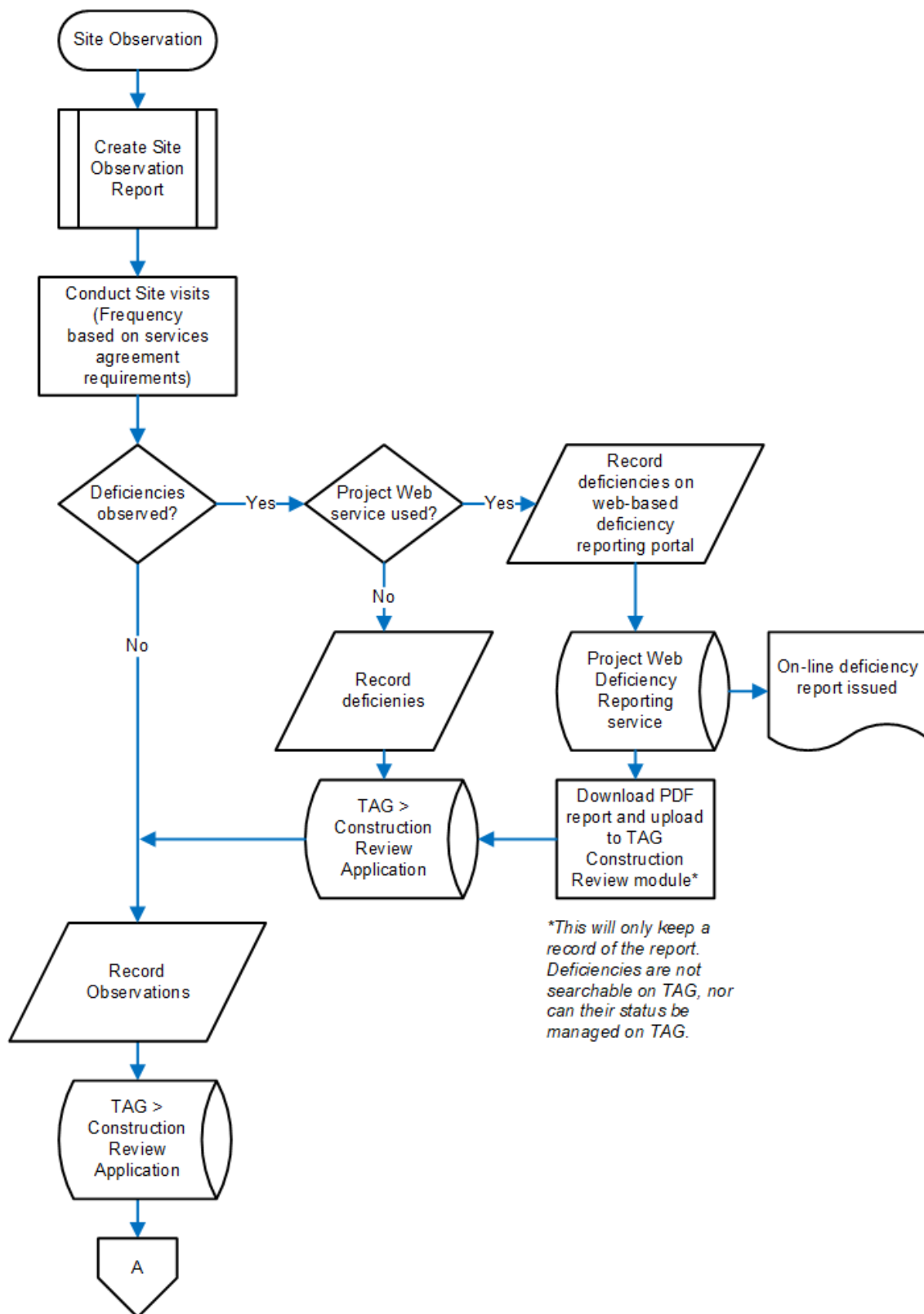


Figure 1: Site Observation – Creating Report

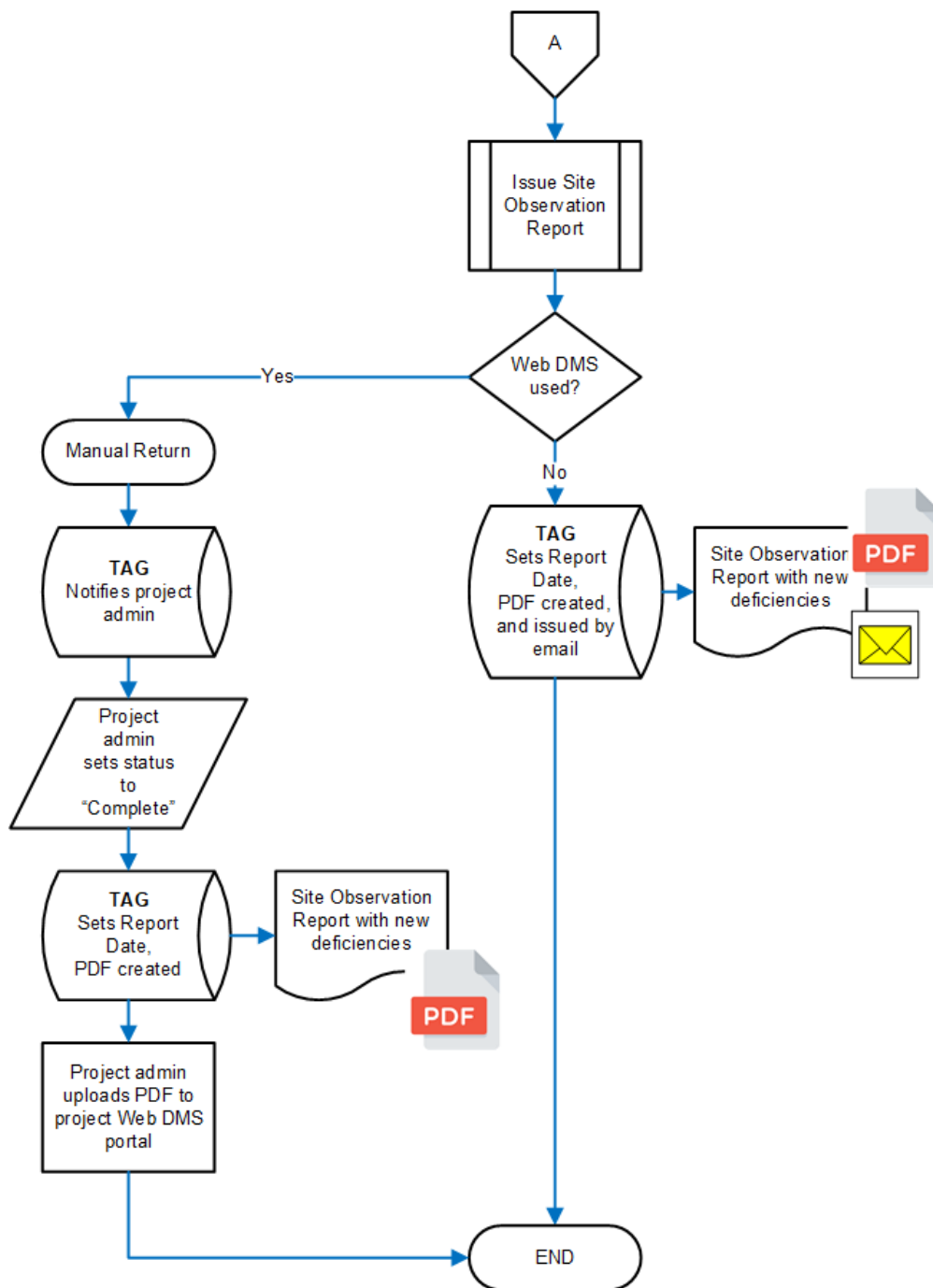


Figure 2: Site Observations - Issuing Reports

2.02 PROGRESS OF THE WORK

- 2.02.01 The main purpose of the site observation report is to provide advice to the owner regarding the progress of the Work and the general quality of workmanship for commercial purposes

related to contractor payments for the work performed. This information can be provide in a variety of methods, including:

- a general narrative form; or
- in a table form, summarizing geographical areas of the building (e.g. floor areas) and by trade.

For reporting the progress of the work for valuation purposes, the work should be divided into various elements such as: by trade or system, by floor, by rough-in vs final fit, etc. The actual detail of breakdown used will vary for each project but should align with the Contractors progress billing breakdown as much as possible.

- 2.02.02 A photo record should be included for specific areas. Photos are often used to record deficiencies, but they should also include general photos that establish a record of work-in-progress at specific locations and times.

NOTE: Dated photo records of general work-in-progress are invaluable to help defend a contractor delay claim at the end of the project, especially where the photo illustrates the state of work on particular dates as compared to the contractors schedule.

The photos shall be organized by date. A selection of photos (but not all) should be included in the site observation report to support comments regarding progress and general quality of the Work.

2.03 WORK QUALITY

- 2.03.01 It is not the function of the site observation report to perform quality control of the Work. However, such reports should include impressions regards the general quality of the Work.

- 2.03.02 For quality of workmanship, this is limited to a general opinion of the subject, and will take into consideration the organization of the project (materials storage, control of work areas, etc), and job-site cleanliness (debris is cleaned each day, etc). Compliance with other issues that are directly specified regarding handling and installation of materials are also evaluated such as:

- (1) conduit, piping and ductwork are aligned and supported properly;
- (2) incomplete sections of ductwork has ends sealed in plastic;
- (3) equipment is provided with temporary protection during handling.

Only where the reviewer is a qualified tradesman in the applicable trade, or the person has reasonable prior experience in the details of the construction should opinions of the specific workmanship be included.

NOTE: If the person performing the review is a qualified welder then it would be suitable to form an opinion of pipe weld quality.

2.04 GENERAL COMMENTS

- 2.04.01 If required, general comments may be included to record other issues, such as
- (1) contractor submission of a system or equipment test report;
 - (2) recording of an AHJ visit;
 - (3) results of a witnessed demonstration test;
 - (4) identification of rooms which have been completed and have been reviewed.
- 2.04.02 Where a test report or AHJ report is submitted, it is to be included with the Site Observation report.

2.05 DEFICIENCIES

- 2.05.01 Deficiencies in workmanship or completeness of the work are not normally included in a Site Observation report, as the work has not yet been declared completed by the Contractor.
- However, should a deficiency in material or workmanship be observed, this deficiency should be brought to the attention of the Contractor in writing in the Site Observation report. It is important to provide notice of such deficiencies as and when they are observed.
- 2.05.02 Similarly, incomplete work is not normally identified unless the Contractor has declared all or a portion of the Work is completed. The exception will be where work elements are missing or incomplete and the affected Work is about to be concealed such as:
- Pipe riser supports, anchors or guides located in a vertical service space, and the service space is about to be enclosed;
 - Pipe or duct insulation missing where about to be concealed in a shaft or above a ceiling.
- 2.05.03 Refer to Practice Instruction 6.01.04 *Deficiency Reporting* for instructions on deficiency reviews and reporting.

2.06 REPORT PREPARATION AND DISTRIBUTION

- 2.06.01 Site Observation reports are to be prepared on and issued by the TAG Project Services > Construction Review application.

NOTE: As this application is new, legacy projects shall use the office standard Site Observation Word forms available on TAG > Document Center.

- 2.06.02 Copies of these reports are to be distributed to the Prime Consultant, Owner, and Contractor in accordance with the project requirements. Copies of these reports may be submitted to the municipal Chief Building Official if requested.

2.07 **SITE OBSERVATION LOG/REPORT**

2.07.01 A site observation report-tracking log shall be maintained and include at a minimum:

- (1) site visit date;
- (2) report issue date; and
- (3) if deficiencies were reported.

NOTE: Where site observation reports are created on TAG, this report log is automatically created.

2.08 **SITE OBSERVATION AUDIT**

2.08.01 The Engineer-of-Record is responsible to review the reports before or after they are issued.

2.09 **FORMS**

2.09.01 The following is a sample Site Observation report form.

End of Section



1127 Leslie Street
Toronto, Ontario
M3C 2J6

T 416 443 8200
F 416 443 8290
hhangus.com

SITE OBSERVATION REPORT

Project: [Title]
Location: Click here to enter text.
Contractor: Click here to enter text.
Building Permit Number: Click here to enter text.

Project No.: Click here to enter text.
Report No.: Click here to enter text.
Date of Visit: Click here to enter a date.
Report Date: Click here to enter a date.

Sheet: 1 OF 1

Reason for Site Visit: Click here to enter text.

Present: Click here to enter text.

The comments included in this site observation report describe only those items observed at the time of the visit, and are not to be construed as a detailed evaluation of the progress of the work or the state of compliance with the Contract Documents. It is the responsibility of the contractor(s) to conduct their own checks to determine compliance with the Contract Documents.

The correction of any noted deficiencies must be confirmed in writing before a further review will be carried out.

Section A - Progress Summary

1. Sample text
 2. Sample text
- Paragraph continuation (un-numbered)
- (1) List
 - (2) List
 - (3) List

Section B - Deficiencies Note on Completed Work

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

Distribution:

- ✓ Project File
- ✓ Owner
- ✓ Prime Consultant
- ✓ GM/CM

H.H. Angus & Associates Limited

Prepared by: Click here to enter text.